

Fate's Edge

Complete Character Sheets

Core + 13 Specialized Builds

How to Use This Document

Each build includes: a **build guidance page** (tips, progression, key choices) followed by a **character sheet page**. Print double-sided or use separate sheets. All sheets share the same visual language for table consistency.

# Character Creation Walkthrough

Before You Begin: The Philosophy

*“Do not try to build a ‘perfect’ character. Build one who owes a debt, carries a scar, and has a name that someone will remember. The numbers will follow the story—not the other way around.”*

— The Gray Wanderer

Key principles to embrace:

- **Flavor is free** — describe your character however you want; mechanics don’t limit creativity
- **Boons are not XP tokens** — spend them freely; hoarding starves the table of drama
- **Embrace failure** — Partial and Misses make the story interesting
- **You manage your own resources** — track your own Obligation, Fatigue, Boons

## Step 1: Concept Seed (5 minutes)

Start with a simple sentence that answers three questions:

- 1. **Who are you?** (ancestry, origin)
- 2. **What do you do?** (profession, role)
- 3. **What defines you?** (a trait, a debt, a scar)

| Sample Concepts |                                                                                                    |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Concept         | Sentence                                                                                           |
| Duelist         | “A Vhasian exile who lost everything in a duel and now fights to reclaim her name.”                |
| Hedge Witch     | “An Aelaerem village healer who learned magic from her grandmother—and inherited her debts.”       |
| Runekeeper      | “An Aeler tunnel-wright who broke a seal in the deep ways and now serves the Patron who answered.” |
| Rogue           | “A Silkstrand gutter rat who picked the wrong pocket and now owes a crime lord.”                   |

**Sample Build (Sage):** *“A Vhasian duelist who lost his family’s charter in a rigged trial. He carries his father’s sword and a vow to restore his house’s name—or die trying.”*

## Step 2: Choose Your Role (5 minutes)

Your primary role determines your primary Attribute.

| The Five Roles    |                    |     |                             |                             |
|-------------------|--------------------|-----|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Role              | Primary<br>tribute | At- | What You Do                 | Example                     |
| Striker (melee)   | Body               |     | Stand in front, deal damage | Fighter, barbarian, duelist |
| Ranger (ranged)   | Wits               |     | Shoot from distance, scout  | Archer, hunter              |
| Face (social)     | Presence           |     | Talk, negotiate, deceive    | Diplomat, courtier          |
| Mage (magic)      | Spirit or Wits     |     | Cast spells, solve problems | Wizard, runekeeper          |
| Support (healing) | Spirit             |     | Heal, protect, aid          | Cleric, healer              |

Sage’s choice: Striker (melee damage) → **Primary Attribute: Body**

Step 3: Set Attributes (5 minutes)

You have **32 XP** to spend on Attributes. Each starts at 1. Cost: **new rating × 3 XP**.

| Recommended Starting Arrays |      |      |        |          |          |
|-----------------------------|------|------|--------|----------|----------|
| Build Type                  | Body | Wits | Spirit | Presence | Total XP |
| Striker (melee)             | 3    | 2    | 1      | 1        | 21       |
| Ranger (archer)             | 2    | 3    | 1      | 1        | 21       |
| Face (social)               | 1    | 2    | 1      | 3        | 21       |
| Mage (spellcaster)          | 1    | 3    | 2      | 1        | 21       |
| Support (healer)            | 1    | 2    | 3      | 1        | 21       |
| Balanced                    | 2    | 2    | 2      | 2        | 24       |

Sage’s Attributes:

| Attribute | Rating | Cost Calculation  | XP    |
|-----------|--------|-------------------|-------|
| Body      | 3      | 1→2 (6) + 2→3 (9) | 15    |
| Wits      | 2      | 1→2 (6)           | 6     |
| Spirit    | 1      | —                 | 0     |
| Presence  | 1      | —                 | 0     |
| Total     |        |                   | 21 XP |

Remaining XP: 32 - 21 = 11 XP

Step 4: Choose Your Skills (5 minutes)

Skills start at 0. Cost: **new level** × 2 XP.

| Skill List by Category |           |             |               |          |
|------------------------|-----------|-------------|---------------|----------|
| Combat                 | Physical  | Social      | Knowledge     | Magic    |
| Melee                  | Athletics | Sway        | Lore          | Arcana   |
| Ranged                 | Stealth   | Command     | Investigation | Ritual   |
| Brawl                  | Endurance | Deception   | Medicine      | Psionics |
| Tactics                | Craft     | Performance |               |          |
|                        | Survival  | Insight     |               |          |

Sage’s Skills:

| Skill     | Rating | Cost Calculation | XP   |
|-----------|--------|------------------|------|
| Melee     | 1      | 0→1 (2)          | 2    |
| Athletics | 1      | 0→1 (2)          | 2    |
| Endurance | 1      | 0→1 (2)          | 2    |
| Total     |        |                  | 6 XP |

Remaining XP: 11 - 6 = 5 XP

Step 5: Choose Talents (5 minutes)

Talents are special abilities. Costs vary by power level.

| Talent Tiers |         |                                     |
|--------------|---------|-------------------------------------|
| Tier         | XP Cost | Scope                               |
| Minor        | 2-3 XP  | Small situational bonus, once/scene |
| Major        | 4-6 XP  | Strong upgrade, permanent effect    |
| Prestige     | 7-10 XP | Campaign-defining                   |
| Epic         | 11+ XP  | Legendary ability                   |

Sage’s Talent:

| Talent                     | XP | Effect                                       |
|----------------------------|----|----------------------------------------------|
| Weapon Mastery (longsword) | 5  | +2 dice with longsword, once/scene +1 Effect |

Remaining XP: 5 - 5 = 0 XP

Step 6: Choose a Patron (Optional, 5 minutes)

For non-magical characters, skip this step. For magical characters, choose a Patron.

| Recommended First Patrons |                   |                          |                      |
|---------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| Patron                    | Domain            | Best For                 | Obligation Style     |
| The Traveler              | Roads, journeys   | Guides, scouts, couriers | Low, forgiving       |
| Oath of Flame & Light     | Vows, radiance    | Paladins, clerics        | Moderate, smiting    |
| The Witness               | Truth, memory     | Investigators, judges    | Moderate, revelation |
| Ikasha                    | Shadow, secrets   | Rogues, spies            | Moderate, stealth    |
| Inaea                     | Mercy, connection | Healers, guardians       | Low, community       |

Sage is non-magical → no Patron.

Step 7: Bonds & Complications (Optional, +XP)

You may take up to **two total** from any mix (e.g., 1 Bond + 1 Complication, or 2 Bonds, or 2 Complications). Each gives **+2 XP**, max **+4 XP**.

**Bonds (+2 XP each):** A mutual relationship with another PC. Once per session, when you act on the Bond with intricate description, **both gain 1 Boon**.

**Complications (+2 XP each):** A burden your character carries. Each unresolved Complication adds **+1 banked Story Beat** to early scenes.

Sage’s Choices:

| Type         | Name         | Description                                              |
|--------------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Bond         | Lyra (rogue) | “She helped me escape the trial that ruined my family.”  |
| Complication | —            | “The magistrate who condemned my family still hunts me.” |

**Bonus XP:** +4 (1 Bond + 1 Complication)

**Starting XP:** 32 + 4 = **36 XP total**

Step 8: Gear & Final Touches (5 minutes)

Starting Gear (assumed free):

- One set of clothing appropriate to your culture
- A melee weapon (Light or Medium) or a ranged weapon with ammunition
- Light armor (or Medium if your concept demands it)
- A backpack, waterskin, 1d6 days of rations, a knife, flint and steel, a small lantern or candle

- Tools for any skill you have at level 1+

**Buying Better Gear (XP costs):**

| Item                            | XP     |
|---------------------------------|--------|
| Light weapon (e.g., dagger)     | 4      |
| Medium weapon (e.g., longsword) | 8      |
| Heavy weapon (e.g., greatsword) | 12     |
| Light armor                     | 4      |
| Medium armor                    | 8      |
| Heavy armor                     | 12     |
| Shield (buckler/heater/pavise)  | 4/8/12 |

**Sage's Gear (starting, free):**

- Longsword (Medium weapon)
- Light armor
- Traveler's clothes
- Backpack, waterskin, rations, knife, flint and steel, lantern

Step 9: Complete the Character Sheet

Sage — Completed Sheet

|               |                                                                                                                              |                    |           |  |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------|--|
| Identity      | Name:                                                                                                                        | Sage               |           |  |
|               | Heritage:                                                                                                                    | Human (Vhasian)    |           |  |
|               | Background:                                                                                                                  | Dispossessed noble |           |  |
|               | Tier / XP:                                                                                                                   | I / 36             |           |  |
| Attributes    | Body: 3                                                                                                                      | Wits: 2            | Spirit: 1 |  |
|               |                                                                                                                              | Presence: 1        |           |  |
| Skills        | Melee: 1                                                                                                                     | Athletics: 1       |           |  |
|               | Endurance: 1                                                                                                                 |                    |           |  |
| Talents       | Weapon Mastery (longsword) — +2 dice, once/scene<br>+1 Effect                                                                |                    |           |  |
| Resources     | Fatigue: 0 / 3                                                                                                               | Harm: 0 / 3        |           |  |
|               | Boons: 0 / 5                                                                                                                 | XP (unspent): 0    |           |  |
| Bonds         | “She helped me escape the trial that ruined my family.” — Lyra                                                               |                    |           |  |
| Complications | “The magistrate who condemned my family still hunts me.” (+1<br>banked SB)                                                   |                    |           |  |
| Gear          | Longsword (Medium weapon), Light armor, traveler’s clothes,<br>backpack, waterskin, rations, knife, flint and steel, lantern |                    |           |  |
| Combat Stats  | Melee pool: Body 3 + Melee 1 +<br>WM 2 = 6 dice                                                                              |                    |           |  |
|               | Defense DV: Body 3 + Athletics<br>1 = 4                                                                                      |                    |           |  |
|               | Armor: Light (Harm 1 → Fa-<br>tigue 1)                                                                                       |                    |           |  |
|               |                                                                                                                              |                    |           |  |

Step 10: Calculate Derived Stats

- **Fatigue Track** = Body rating (**3** for Sage)
- **Obligation Capacity** = Spirit + Presence (**2** for Sage; not applicable as non-magical)
- **Harm Track** = Always 3 boxes
- **Boon Cap** = Always 5 (trim to 2 at scene end)

## Quick Reference: XP Spending Summary

### XP Costs

| Improvement                     | Cost Formula          | Example                        |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------|
| Attribute                       | new rating $\times$ 3 | Body 1 $\rightarrow$ 3 = 15 XP |
| Skill                           | new level $\times$ 2  | Melee 1 $\rightarrow$ 2 = 4 XP |
| Minor Talent                    | 2-3 XP                | Keen Senses = 2 XP             |
| Major Talent                    | 4-6 XP                | Weapon Mastery = 5 XP          |
| Light weapon (e.g., dagger)     | 4 XP                  | Dagger = 4 XP                  |
| Medium weapon (e.g., longsword) | 8 XP                  | Longsword = 8 XP               |
| Heavy weapon (e.g., greatsword) | 12 XP                 | Greatsword = 12 XP             |
| Light armor                     | 4 XP                  | Leather = 4 XP                 |
| Medium armor                    | 8 XP                  | Chainmail = 8 XP               |
| Heavy armor                     | 12 XP                 | Plate = 12 XP                  |
| Follower                        | Cap <sup>2</sup> XP   | Cap 3 follower = 9 XP          |
| Minor Asset                     | 4 XP                  | Safehouse = 4 XP               |

## Sample Builds at a Glance

### The Duelist (Striker) — 36 XP

|                   |                                          |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b> | Body 3, Wits 2                           |
| <b>Skills</b>     | Melee 2, Athletics 1, Endurance 1        |
| <b>Talents</b>    | Weapon Mastery (5), Disciplined Body (3) |
| <b>Gear</b>       | Longsword, light armor                   |

### The Archer (Ranger) — 36 XP

|                   |                                           |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b> | Wits 3, Body 2                            |
| <b>Skills</b>     | Ranged 2, Survival 2, Stealth 1           |
| <b>Talents</b>    | Weapon Mastery (bow) (5), Keen Senses (2) |
| <b>Gear</b>       | Bow, arrows, light armor                  |

### The Face (Social) — 36 XP

|                   |                                         |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b> | Presence 3, Wits 2                      |
| <b>Skills</b>     | Sway 2, Insight 1, Deception 1          |
| <b>Talents</b>    | Silver Tongue (2), Command Presence (4) |
| <b>Gear</b>       | Dagger (Light weapon), fine clothes     |

**The Runekeeper (Mage) — 36 XP**

|                   |                                     |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Attributes</b> | Spirit 3, Wits 2                    |
| <b>Skills</b>     | Lore 2, Arcana 1, Insight 1         |
| <b>Talents</b>    | Familiar (2), Codex (4)             |
| <b>Rites</b>      | Road-Sense (4), Traveler's Boon (5) |
| <b>Patron</b>     | The Traveler                        |

**Final Checklist**

Before your first session:

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A one-sentence concept

Attributes assigned (total 21-24 XP typical)

2-3 key skills at level 1-2

1-3 talents (2-10 XP total)

Bonds (0-2, +2 XP each)

Complications (0-2, +2 XP each)

Starting gear (free or XP-purchased)

Fatigue and Harm tracks filled in

Boons at 0/5

Obligation at 0 (if applicable)

A name your character would answer to

**The Gray Wanderer's Last Word**

*"Now close the book. Go make some mistakes. I will be at the inn, buying the wine with a coin that shouldn't exist, waiting to hear what road you choose."*

Your character sheet is not your character. It is a tool to help you tell their story. The numbers will change. The scars will accumulate. The debts will come due.

That is not a problem. That is the game.

**Welcome to Fate's Edge. The road is waiting.**

## Core Character Sheet — Build Guidance

### Core Sheet — First Steps

**Start here.** This sheet works for any character. Fill out Identity, Attributes, Skills, then track resources.

#### Key Choices:

- **Primary Attribute:** Body (melee), Wits (rogue/caster), Spirit (magic), Presence (face)
- **Key Skills:** Choose 2-3 at level 2, rest at 0-1
- **Talents:** 1-3 talents (2-6 XP each)
- **Bonds:** Take 2 bonds with other PCs (+4 XP total)

#### Resource Management:

- **Boons:** Max 5; trim to 2 at scene end. Spend freely!
- **Fatigue:** Each point worsens Position. Full track → Harm+1
- **Obligation:** Track per Patron; Capacity = Spirit + Presence

Core Character Sheet — Page 1

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Talents

Attributes

| Attribute | Rating | Derived                            |
|-----------|--------|------------------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue: <div></div> / <div></div> |
| Wits      |        | Harm: <div></div> / <div>3</div>   |
| Spirit    |        | Obligation Cap: <div></div>        |
| Presence  |        | Boons: <div></div> / <div>5</div>  |

Equipment

Bonds & Strings

Bonds (PCs):

Strings (NPCs):

Skills

| Combat          | Physical      | Social       |
|-----------------|---------------|--------------|
| Melee:          | Athletics:    | Sway:        |
| Ranged:         | Stealth:      | Command:     |
| Brawl:          | Endurance:    | Deception:   |
| Tactics:        | Craft:        | Performance: |
|                 | Survival:     | Insight:     |
| Knowledge Lore: | Magic Arcana: |              |
| Investigation:  | Ritual:       |              |
| Medicine:       | Psionics:     |              |

*"The ledger is never closed. It is only passed to the next keeper." — Dusana of the Raven Road*

Core Character Sheet — Page 2 (Combat Reference)

| Weapons    |       |
|------------|-------|
| Weapon     | Stats |
| Primary:   |       |
| Secondary: |       |
| Ranged:    |       |

| Armor & Defense |  |
|-----------------|--|
| Armor Type:     |  |
| Armor Rating:   |  |
| Shield:         |  |
| Defense DV:     |  |

| Notes & Goals |
|---------------|
|               |

| Combat Quick Reference |                                  |
|------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Action                 | Effect                           |
| Attack                 | Melee/ranged vs DV               |
| Defend                 | +1 Position, protect ally        |
| Disengage              | Move without OA                  |
| Charge                 | Move 2 bands + attack, 1 Fatigue |
| Shove                  | Push target 1 band               |
| Grapple                | Restrain, -1 die to target       |
| Aid                    | Spend 1 Boon for +1 die          |

| Armor Conversion Table |        |            |            |
|------------------------|--------|------------|------------|
| Armor                  | Harm 1 | Harm 2     | Harm 3     |
| Light                  | Fat 1  | Harm1+Fat1 | Harm2+Fat1 |
| Medium                 | Fat 1  | Fat 1      | Harm2+Fat1 |
| Heavy                  | Fat 1  | Fat 1      | Fat 2      |

## Melee Combat Specialist — Build Guidance

### The Tank / Striker — Frontline Combat

**Role:** Stand in the shield wall, absorb harm, deal damage. Primary: Body.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Weapon Mastery (5 XP)** – +2 dice with chosen weapon
- **Disciplined Body (3 XP)** – Convert 1 Harm to Fatigue, +1 die unarmed
- **Second Wind (2 XP)** – Clear 1 Fatigue

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I (0-40 XP):** Body 3, Melee 2, Athletics 1. Take Weapon Mastery + Disciplined Body.
- **Tier II (41-90 XP):** Body 4, take Iron Resilience (+2 Harm boxes). Add Shield Bearer if using shield.
- **Tier III (91-150 XP):** Take Sentinel chain (Stand Fast → Unmovable → Shield of the Fallen).

**Tactical Tips:**

- Use Defend action when outnumbered; it improves Position and protects allies.
- Spend Boons on re-rolling failed defense rolls, not offense.
- Taking Harm clears Fatigue — sometimes a small wound is worth the reset.

Melee Combat Specialist — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

/

Attributes & Combat Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
|           |        |          | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
|           |        |          | / 5*      |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
|           |        |          | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

silience gives +2 Harm boxes

\*Iron

Re-

Combat Stats

| Weapon     | Damage / Effect          |
|------------|--------------------------|
| Primary:   |                          |
| Secondary: |                          |
| Armor      | Conversion               |
| Light:     | Harm 1 → Fatigue 1       |
| Medium:    | Harm 2 → Fatigue 1       |
| Heavy:     | Harm 3 → Fatigue 2       |
| Shield     | Effect                   |
| Buckler:   | +1d Defend melee         |
| Heater:    | Convert 1 Harm → Fatigue |

Combat Talents

**Weapon Mastery (5 XP):** +2 dice with chosen weapon. Once/scene, +1 Effect.

**Disciplined Body (3 XP):** +1 die unarmed. Once/scene, convert 1 Harm to Fatigue.

**Shield Bearer (4 XP):** +1 Armor with shield. Protect action.

**Iron Resilience (6 XP):** +2 Harm boxes; survive 0 Harm once/scene.

**Sentinel — Stand Fast (4 XP):** Defensive stance, enemies suffer −1 die to attack you.

Weapon Modifiers

| Weight | Close | Near | Notes             |
|--------|-------|------|-------------------|
| Light  | +2d   | +1d  | Fast, concealable |
| Medium | +1d   | +2d  | Set once/scene    |
| Heavy  | -1d   | +3d  | Set once/scene    |

Cultural Variant: Dhaharan Elephant Rider

**Mahout's Bond (6 XP):** Bond with war elephant; melee reach Near, +1 Armor.

"The tank is the anvil. The striker is the hammer. Know which you are before the drum sounds." — Master Tarian

## Rogue / Infiltrator — Build Guidance

### The Shadow — Stealth and Subterfuge

**Role:** Infiltrate, steal, strike from darkness. Primary: Wits, Body.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Light Fingers (2 XP)** – First Stealth/Subterfuge roll Position +1
- **The Unlocked Window (2 XP)** – Ignore one security obstacle per session
- **Backstab (6 XP)** – +1 Harm from stealth, ignore 1 Armor

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Wits 3, Stealth 2, Subterfuge 2. Take Light Fingers + Unlocked Window.
- **Tier II:** Add Backstab, then Shadow Dance. Take Crowd Veil.
- **Tier III:** Deathblow (triple Harm from Dominant Position).

**Patron Recommendations:**

- **Ikasha (Shadow):** Shadow Meld, The Unobserved. Best for ghost thieves.
- **Livaea (Social):** Golden Tongue, Velvet Invitation. Best for con artists.
- **Aveh (Fugitive):** Escape Clause, Forgotten Face. Best for runners.

Rogue / Infiltrator — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

/

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Rogue Talents

Light Fingers (2 XP):

The Unlocked Window (2 XP):

Backstab (6 XP):

Crowd Veil (4 XP):

Shadow Dance (10 XP):

First Stealth/Subterfuge roll Position +1.

Ignore one security obstacle per session.

+1 Harm from Stealth, ignore 1 Armor. On miss, Exposed.

Vanish into crowds. Stealth vs DV 3 to become Hidden.

After Backstab, roll Stealth to re-enter Stealth.

Ikasha's Shadow Arts (Optional)

Shadow Meld (6 XP):

The Unobserved (8 XP):

Step into shadow, emerge from another within Near.

When Hidden, cannot be framed; witnesses -2 dice to recall face.

Tools of the Trade

| Item          | Effect      |
|---------------|-------------|
| Lockpicks:    | <div></div> |
| Poison:       | <div></div> |
| Disguise kit: | <div></div> |
| Smokebomb:    | <div></div> |

Signature Gear

Light Weapon (4 XP):

Throwing Knives (4 XP):

Leather Armor (4 XP):

Silk Rope:

+2d Close, +1d Near. Concealable.

Ranged, Fast tempo.

Harm 1 → Fatigue 1.

"The coin that never spends is the one you don't remember taking." — Madam Serafine

## Face / Socialite — Build Guidance

### The Diplomat — Social Combat Specialist

**Role:** Negotiate, deceive, inspire, command. Primary: Presence, Wits.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Silver Tongue (2 XP)** – +1 die to persuasion
- **Command Presence (4 XP)** – +1 die to leadership/intimidation
- **Network Weaver (4 XP)** – Gain minor contact in each new settlement

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Presence 3, Sway 2, Insight 1. Take Silver Tongue + Command Presence.
- **Tier II:** Add Network Weaver, Trusted Reputation. Raise Wits to 3.
- **Tier III:** Spymaster (ask one detailed question about faction movements per session).

**Patron Recommendations:**

- **Livaea (Seduction):** Golden Tongue, Velvet Invitation, The Unrefusable Offer.
- **The Witness (Truth):** Rite of Uncomfortable Question, Echoing Truth.
- **Palinode (Performance):** Hymn Against Dread, The Hooked Chorus.

Face / Socialite — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Social Talents

Silver Tongue (2 XP): +1 die to persuasion attempts.

Command Presence (4 XP): +1 die to leadership and intimidation.

Network Weaver (4 XP): Gain a minor contact in each new settlement.

Trusted Reputation (4 XP): Once/session, call in a minor favor from a friendly faction.

Spymaster (8 XP): Once/session, ask one detailed question about faction movements.

Livaea's Social Arts (Optional)

Golden Tongue (Low Rite, 4 XP): +2 dice to Sway for one exchange. Costs 1 Fatigue.

The Velvet Invitation (Low Rite, 4 XP): Automatic entry to any private social function.

The Unrefusable Offer (Standard, 9 XP): Target must accept offer or suffer -2 dice.

Social Combat Reference

| Action      | Effect                               |
|-------------|--------------------------------------|
| Persuade    | Presence + Sway vs DV                |
| Intimidate  | Presence + Command vs DV             |
| Lie         | Presence + Deception vs Insight      |
| Inspire     | Presence + Performance, grant +1 die |
| Read Person | Wits + Insight, detect lies          |

Influence Trackers

Velvet Court Reputation: \_\_\_\_\_

Faction Standing: \_\_\_\_\_

"A smile can open a door that a key cannot. A secret can close it forever." — Madam Serafine

## Runekeeper — Build Guidance

### The Agent of Covenant — Structured Magic

**Role:** Reliable magic through Patron covenant. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Familiar (Thiasos) (2 XP)** – Bond to Patron
- **Codex (4 XP)** – Book of Rites
- **Patron's Gift (free)** – Imbue item for +1 die

**First Patron Recommendation: The Traveler** (low Obligation, useful Rites)

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Spirit 3, Lore 2. Take Familiar + Codex + two Low Rites (4-5 XP each).
- **Tier II:** Add Efficient Invocation. Raise Presence for Obligation capacity.
- **Tier III:** Patron's Favor (ignore Obligation cost once/session).

**Obligation Management:**

- Capacity = Spirit + Presence
- Exceeding capacity: 1 Fatigue per segment over
- Clear Obligation via Acts of Service to your Patron

Runekeeper — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

/

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Obligation Tracker

Capacity: Spirit + Presence =

Current Obligation: /

Obligation Overflow: Each segment over Capacity = 1 Fatigue.

Codex & Thiasos

Codex:

Thiasos (Familiar):

Rites Known

Low Rites (Obligation 4-5):

Standard Rites (Obligation 6-8):

High Rites (Obligation 7-8):

Runekeeper Talents

Efficient Invocation (4 XP): Reduce Obligation of one Low Rite by 1.

Patron's Favor (8 XP): Once/session, ignore Obligation cost.

Patron's Dedication (4 XP): Bind to single Patron; sing other Patron's Songs at worse Position.

Sample Build — The Traveler's Runekeeper (36XP)

Attributes: Spirit 3 (9), Wits 2 (6) — 15 XP

Skills: Lore 2 (4), Insight 1 (2), Sway 1 (2) — 8 XP

Talents: Familiar (2), Codex (4) — 6 XP

Rites: Road-Sense (4), Traveler's Boon (5) — 9 XP

Total: 38 XP (adjust as needed)

"I do not beg. I record. And in the recording, I become the hand that writes the law." — The Gray Wanderer

## Runic Warrior — Build Guidance

### The Spell-Sword — Runes and Steel

**Role:** Frontline caster who writes covenants in flesh and steel. Primary: Body, Spirit.

**Codex Forms:**

- **Flesh Codex (4 XP)** – Rites tattooed on skin. Cannot be stolen. Visible.
- **Stone Codex (4 XP)** – Rites carved on shield/gorget. Can be lost or broken.
- **Steel Codex (6 XP)** – Sentient weapon that speaks. Counts as witness.

**Core Talents:**

- **Flesh Codex (4 XP) + Living Thiasos (3 XP)**
- **Weapon Mastery (5 XP)** – +2 dice with chosen weapon
- **Oath-Bound (4 XP)** – Reroll failed Body roll when serving a sworn oath

**Patron Recommendations for Warriors:**

- **Oath of Flame & Light** – Paladin, smiting, healing
- **Mykkiel** – Law, judgment, binding oaths
- **Grimmir** – Druid, nature, thorns
- **Khemesh** – Warlock, crushing pressure, terror

Runic Warrior — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Combat Rites

Rite of the Kindled Blade (Low, 4 XP):

Rite of the Unbroken Vow (Standard, 7 XP):

Rite of the Sealed Threshold (Standard, 7 XP):

Attributes & Combat Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Obligation as Physical Scar

Minor (1-2):

Moderate (3-4):

Significant (5-6):

Critical (7+):

Runic Warrior Talents

Flesh Codex (4 XP):

Living Thiasos (3 XP):

Oath-Bound (4 XP):

Scarred Resilience (3 XP):

Combat Rites

Rite of the Kindled Blade (Low, 4 XP):

Rite of the Unbroken Vow (Standard, 7 XP):

Rite of the Sealed Threshold (Standard, 7 XP):

Cultural Traditions

Ashaan War-Priest (Mykkiel):

Oshiira Gilded Lancer (Traveler):

Pereshi Cataphract (Witness):

Dhahara Elephant-Rider (Grimmir):

Sample Build — Tier I Dawn Warrior (36XP)

Attributes:

Skills:

Talents:

Rites:

Total:

Attributes & Combat Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Obligation as Physical Scar

Minor (1-2):

Moderate (3-4):

Significant (5-6):

Critical (7+):

Runic Warrior Talents

Flesh Codex (4 XP):

Living Thiasos (3 XP):

Oath-Bound (4 XP):

Scarred Resilience (3 XP):

"Carve your vows into your flesh. Let your scars be your scripture." — Master Tarian

## Invoker — Build Guidance

### The Gambler — Power Without Bondage

**Role:** Borrow power from multiple Patrons; versatile but risky. Primary: Wits, Spirit.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Patron's Symbol (4 XP each)** – Physical anchor to a Patron. Max 4 Symbols.
- **Ritual Mastery (4 XP)** – Reduce backlash SB by 1

**Symbol Management:**

- Displaying Symbol reduces DV by 1 and Obligation by 1 (min 0)
- **Crack the Seal:** Resolve Rite instantly; Symbol becomes Compromised, double Obligation
- **Cross-Resonance:** Carrying multiple Symbols creates friction. Limit 4.

**Recommended Patrons for Invokers:**

- **Morag the Hag** – Hidden costs, bargains, Speaking Knot
- **The Confessor** – Burden sharing, confession magic
- **The Ninth** – Hyperknowledge, information overflow
- **Ikasha** – Shadow, stealth, thresholds

Invoker — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Symbols & Obligation

| Patron | Symbol | Oblig | Status |
|--------|--------|-------|--------|
| 1:     |        |       |        |
| 2:     |        |       |        |
| 3:     |        |       |        |
| 4:     |        |       |        |

Total Obligation:  /  (Spirit + Presence)

Invoker Talents

**Borrowed Grace (Free):** Spend 1 Boon or 1 Fatigue for +1 die. Mark +1 Obligation.

**Crack Specialist (6 XP):** Reduce Obligation cost of Crack the Seal by 1.

**Symbol Resonance (4 XP):** +1 die to ritual roll when using a Symbol.

**Ritual Mastery (4 XP):** Reduce backlash SB by 1; first SB each scene becomes your Boon.

Ritual Invocation

**Time:** Significant Time (DV in rounds)

**Cost:** Mark Rite's Obligation

**Symbol Benefit:** If displayed, reduce DV by 1 and Obligation by 1 (min 0)

**Crack the Seal:** Resolve instantly. Set Symbol to Compromised, mark double Obligation.

Recommended Invoker Patrons

**Morag the Hag:** Speaking Knot, Threefold Exchange, Crossroads Court.

**The Confessor:** Echo of Sin, Burden Transference, The Cauldron's Secret.

**The Ninth:** Ninth Figure, Hypercognitive Lattice, The Ninth Revelation.

**Ikasha:** Touch the Umbral Veil, Umbral Reservoir, Become the Shadow.

"I do not serve. I rent. And when the landlord comes to collect, I had best have the coin ready." — The Gray Wanderer

## Threadweaver (Free Caster) — Build Guidance

### The Weaver of Raw Magic — Improvisational Casting

**Role:** Improvise spells using the TAGS system. Versatile but risky. Primary: Wits, Spirit.

**TAGS System:** DV = 1 + number of tags. Dangerous tags (Leap, Gate, Transform) add +2 DV.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Spellcraft (6 XP)** – Required for free casting
- **Practiced Caster (2 XP)** – Reduce cantrip DV by 1 (min 1)
- **Controlled Burn (4 XP)** – Convert a 1 into a Boon (GM does not gain SB)

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Wits 3, Arcana 2. Take Spellcraft + Practiced Caster.
- **Tier II:** Add Controlled Burn + Weave Resilience. Choose Elemental Focus.
- **Tier III:** Spell Echo, Resonance Anchor, Elemental Attunement.
- **Tier IV-V:** Weave Harmonist (ignore all SB from one cast per session).

**Backlash Severity:**

- **Minor (1-2 SB):** Fatigue +1, -1 die next roll
- **Major (3-4 SB):** Harm 1, Condition, ward collapse
- **Catastrophic (5+ SB):** Harm 2, permanent Scar, reality fracture

Threadweaver (Free Caster) — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

| Attributes & Resources |        |          |           |
|------------------------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Attribute              | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
| Body                   |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits                   |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit                 |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence               |        | XP       |           |

Free Casting — The TAGS System

DV = 1 + number of TAGS (Dangerous: +2 DV)

Casting Roll: Wits + Arcana vs DV. Each 1 = SB for GM.

Backlash (on Miss or GM spending SB):

• Harm 2 (Arcane) • +2 Fatigue • Corruption +1 • Catastrophic side effect

| TAG Library Quick Reference |                |          |                      |
|-----------------------------|----------------|----------|----------------------|
| Tag                         | Effect         | Tag      | Effect               |
| Burning                     | Fire, heat     | Freezing | Ice, cold            |
| Storm                       | Lightning      | Stone    | Earth, spikes        |
| Wave                        | Water          | Wind     | Air, gusts           |
| Force                       | Kinetic blast  | Area     | Zone effect          |
| Strike                      | Single target  | Wall     | Barrier              |
| Bind                        | Restrain       | Dispel   | Suppress magic       |
| Veil                        | Conceal        | Scry     | Reveal               |
| HEAL                        | Remove Fatigue | Leap     | Teleport (dangerous) |

Signature Spells

Ember Flick (DV 2): [Burning][Strike] – Ignite small object, 1 Fatigue.

Reed Walk (DV 3): [Wind][Leap][Self] – Leap Far, ignore OAs.

Grasping Roots (DV 3): [Earth][Bind][Area] – Entangle zone.

Shield of Air (DV 3): [Ward][Defend] – +1 Position on defense.

Fate's Needle (DV 5): [Fate][Strike] – Roll 3d10, keep highest for auto-successes.

"Free casting is the mud between the cobbles, the river beneath the bridge. It has no patron to catch you when you fall." — Lysandra of the Amber Gate

## Cantor — Build Guidance

### The Touched Voice — Song as Power

**Role:** Magic through performance. Corruption is transformation, not punishment. Primary: Presence, Spirit.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Cantor's Path (8 XP)** – Required for songs
- **Steady Voice (2 XP)** – Push by marking Fatigue instead of Corruption (once/scene)
- **Resonant Performance (3 XP)** – +1 die when performing for 5+ audience

**Corruption Timer :** Size = Spirit. Marks when: Pushing a Song, performing Resonant Rite, or GM spends SB on occult activity.

**When Timer Fills:** Gain boon + burden from last Patron. Reset to Tier (min 1).

**Patrons of the Voice:**

- **Palinode (Queen of Encores)** – Performance, rapture, unfinished art
- **Thrysos (King of Revels)** – Drunken Master, ecstasy, frenzy
- **Livaea (Crimson Courtier)** – Seduction, social binding
- **Ikasha (Shadow)** – Whispers, stealth, forgotten songs

Cantor — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
|           |        |          | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
|           |        |          | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
|           |        |          | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Corruption Timer

Timer Size = Spirit

1

2

3

4

5

6

Current Corruption:

/

When Timer fills:

Gain boon + burden from last Patron. Reset to Tier.

Repertoire

Repertoire Timer [6]

1

2

3

4

5

6

At 2: -1 DV to Songs. At 4: +1 die Performance. At 6: Learn one Standard Rite as Song.

Songs & Performance

Sing a Song:

1 action, resolves next turn. Roll Lore + Performance vs DV.

Push It:

Resolve immediately. Mark 1 Fatigue and mark Corruption. GM gains 1 SB.

Cantor Talents

Resonant Performance (3 XP):

+1 die when performing for 5+ audience.

Song Weaver (4 XP):

Combine two compatible Songs for +1 Effect.

High Cantor (18 XP):

Learn Standard Rites as Songs; resolve instantly.

Sample Songs by Patron

Palinode:

Hymn Against Dread (allies +2 dice resist Fear).

Thrysos:

The Overflowing Cup (allies +1 die social, enemies -1 die).

Livaea:

Golden Tongue (+2 dice to Sway, costs 1 Fatigue).

Ikasha:

Cradle Song (lull target, Resist DV 3).

Sample Build — Kestra the Traveler’s Cantor

Attributes:

Presence 3, Spirit 2, Wits 2 — 21 XP

Skills:

Performance 2, Lore 2, Sway 1 — 10 XP

Talents:

Cantor’s Path (8), Steady Voice (2) — 10 XP

Total:

41 XP

“You think you need a lute? My larynx is older than any tree. Hum, and the world will listen.” — The Gray Wanderer

## Witch — Build Guidance

### The Quiet Architect — Threshold Magic

**Role:** Subtle magic through knots, thresholds, and debts. Primary: Wits, Spirit.

**Hedge Gifts (No Roll):**

- **Steady Hand (2 XP):** Remove 1 Fatigue with touch, once/scene
- **Salt Line (2 XP):** Pour salt line; spirits test to cross
- **Hearth-Sense (2 XP):** Ask GM yes/no about threshold or debt

**The Three Layers:**

- **Echo:** Past memory. Work with knots and cords.
- **Veil:** Present boundary. Work with salt and chalk.
- **Flow:** Direction of change. Work with omission and the Ninth.

**Promise Timers:** Track debts and obligations. Size 4 or 6. When full, price comes due.

**Recommended Patrons for Witches:**

- **Morag the Hag** – Hidden costs, bargains
- **Inaea (Angel of the Spider)** – Webs, mercy, connection
- **Ikasha** – Thresholds, shadows, forgotten things
- **Isoka** – Transformation, shedding, venom

Witch — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  |           |
|           |        |          | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     |           |
|           |        |          | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    |           |
|           |        |          | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Promise Timers

Timer [4]

|   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|

Timer [6]

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Hedge Gifts (No Roll)

Steady Hand:

Warm Hand:

Salt Line:

The Unlit Candle:

Remove 1 Fatigue with touch, once/scene.

Next physical action +1 die (comfort) or -1 die (warning).

Pour salt line; spirits test Spirit+Resolve to cross.

Extinguish light source → dim/dark zone.

Quick Workings (Roll)

Name threshold, choose layer (Echo/Veil/Flow), roll Wits+Lore or Spirit+Insight. Effect: door sticks, candle gutters, pursuer slips.

Witch Patrons

Morag:

Inaea:

Ikasha:

Isoka:

Hidden costs. The Speaking Knot, Threefold Exchange.

Webs of connection. Hearth-Thread Knot, Strand of Inevitability.

Thresholds, shadows. Touch the Umbral Veil.

Transformation, venom. Venomous Benediction, The Shedding.

"The hedge is what keeps the wolves from the flock. I am the one who tends the hedge." — The Gray Wanderer

## Psion — Build Guidance

### The Isolated Mind — Power Within

**Role:** No Patron, no Symbol, no Codex. Power is internal. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

**Mental Strain:** Capacity = Spirit. Separate from Fatigue. Does not clear when taking Harm.

**Overflow:** When cannot pay Mental Strain:

- Convert to +2 Fatigue, or
- Convert to +1 Harm (Stress)

Exceeding Capacity: +1 Harm, set Mental Strain to max.

**Core Talents (Must Have):**

- **Psionics Skill (0-5)** – Gates access to Arts
- **Mental Fortress (8 XP)** – +2 dice resist psychic intrusion
- **Psychic Reservoir (4 XP)** – Store 1 Mental Strain per session (max Spirit)

**The Nine Arts:**

- Telekinesis, Telepathy, Clairvoyance, Biofeedback
- Astral Projection, Psychic Assault, Mind Shield
- Empathic Manipulation, Precognition

Psion — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource      | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|---------------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue       |           |
|           |        |               | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm          |           |
|           |        |               | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Mental Strain |           |
|           |        |               | /         |
| Presence  |        | XP            |           |
|           |        |               |           |

Mental Strain Tracker

Capacity = Spirit

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

When cannot pay:

Overflow:

Convert to +2 Fatigue or +1 Harm (Stress).

Exceed Capacity → +1 Harm, set Mental Strain to max.

The Nine Arts

| Art                   | Key Attribute |
|-----------------------|---------------|
| Telekinesis           | Spirit        |
| Telepathy             | Wits          |
| Clairvoyance          | Wits          |
| Biofeedback           | Spirit        |
| Astral Projection     | Spirit        |
| Psychic Assault       | Spirit        |
| Mind Shield           | Wits          |
| Empathic Manipulation | Presence      |
| Precognition          | Spirit        |

Psionic Talents

Psionics Skill:

Mental Fortress (8 XP):

Psychic Reservoir (4 XP):

Thought Thief (6 XP):

Mind Walker (10 XP):

+2 dice resist psychic intrusion.

Store 1 Mental Strain/session (max Spirit).

+1 die Telepathy; learn one surface thought.

Astral Project without body risk (Mental Strain doubled).

Sample Arts by Difficulty

Surface Thoughts (DV 2):

Telekinesis Light (DV 2):

Biofeedback Minor (DV 2):

Psychic Assault (DV 3):

Read current focus.

Move small objects.

Stabilize wounds.

Deal Mental Harm.

"I carry no Symbol. My ledger is my skull, and it comes due in headaches, not obligations." — The Gray Wanderer

## Monk (Unstruck Bell) — Build Guidance

### The Open Hand — Stillness as Weapon

**Role:** Unarmored martial artist. Redirect, avoid, strike precisely. Primary: Body, Wits.

**Three Principles:**

- **The Coin That Does Not Move:** Never resist what cannot be stopped. Yield.
- **The Witness Who Breathes:** Stillness is the greatest disguise.
- **The Debt That Is Never Incurred:** Do not strike first; create no debt.

**Core Talents:**

- **Unarmed Combatant (4 XP)** – Unarmed strikes Harm 1; grapple bonus
- **Disciplined Body (3 XP)** – +1 die unarmed; convert 1 Harm to Fatigue
- **Still Point (2 XP)** – When not moving, +1 die to next defense
- **Monk's Breath (2 XP)** – Clear 1 Fatigue by meditating 1 minute

**Monastic Traditions:**

- **Way of the Unstruck Bell (Ikasha)** – Shadow Meld, The Unobserved
- **Way of the Iron Vow (Mykkiel)** – Sworn Defender, Unyielding Vow
- **Way of the Endless Cup (Thrysos)** – Stagger Step, Drunken Fist

Monk (Unstruck Bell) — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Monastic Tradition:

Tier / XP:

| Attributes & Resources |        |          |           |
|------------------------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Attribute              | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
| Body                   |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits                   |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit                 |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence               |        | XP       |           |

Meditation Tracker

The Four Breaths:

Entering → Holding → Releasing → Empty

Meditation Benefits:

Healing: Clear 1 Fatigue, remove minor Condition

Clarity: +1 die next Wits roll

Transcendent: Reroll any failed roll (GM gains 1 SB)

Monk Talents

Unarmed Combatant (4 XP): Harm 1, grapple bonus.

Disciplined Body (3 XP): +1 die unarmed; convert 1 Harm to Fatigue.

Still Point (2 XP): Not moving → +1 die next defense.

Monk's Breath (2 XP): Clear 1 Fatigue, 1 minute meditation.

Flurry of Blows (6 XP): Three unarmed attacks in one action.

Monastic Tradition Techniques

Way of Unstruck Bell: Shadow Meld (step through shadows).

Way of Iron Vow: Sworn Defender (adjacent ally +1 Armor).

Way of Endless Cup: Stagger Step (move 1 band when enemy misses).

Sample Build — Tier I Unstruck Bell Monk (36XP)

Attributes: Body 3 (9), Wits 3 (9), Spirit 2 (6) — 24 XP

Skills: Stealth 2 (4), Melee 1 (2), Meditation 1 (2) — 8 XP

Talents: Unarmed Combatant (4), Disciplined Body (3), Still Point (2), Monk's Breath (2) — 11 XP

Total: 43 XP (adjust as needed)

"The fist is a weapon. The open hand is a promise. Learn both before you need either." — Brother Tarn

## Summoner — Build Guidance

### The Door-Opener — Binding Spirits

**Role:** Call and bind spirits for aid. Negotiation, not command. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

**Core Talents:**

- **Pact-Whisperer (2 XP)** – Required for summoning
- **Lesser Pactwright (2 XP)** – Summon Cap 1 spirits
- **Greater Pactwright (4 XP)** – Summon Cap 3 spirits
- **Spirit Synergy (4 XP)** – Reduce each summoned spirit's Leash by 1

**Leash Mechanics:**

- **Capacity:** Cap + Spirit segments
- **Ticks when:** Spirit takes Harm, acts against nature, crosses a [WARD], split focus
- **Boon Finesse:** Spend 1 Boon to clear 1 Leash tick (once/round)
- **When full:** Spirit acts once to its nature, then departs (or turns hostile)

**Spirit Types:**

- **Vein-Serpent (Aeler):** Locates ore, stabilizes tunnels
- **Wolf-Ancestor (Ykrul):** Tracks, guards, teaches battle-songs
- **Selkie-Maid (Linn):** Navigation, drowning, retrieving objects
- **Drowned Mutineer (Zakov):** Sabotage, whispers, curses

Summoner — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Summoning Mechanics

Call (1 action):

Manifest spirit at Near range.

Bind:

Spend 1 Boon or mark 1 Fatigue.

Leash Capacity:

Cap + Spirit =

Current Leash:

/

Boon Finesse:

Spend 1 Boon to clear 1 Leash tick (once/round).

Summoner Talents

Pact-Whisperer (2 XP):

Required for summoning.

Lesser Pactwright (2 XP):

Summon Cap 1 spirits.

Greater Pactwright (4 XP):

Summon Cap 3 spirits.

Spirit Synergy (4 XP):

Reduce each spirit's Leash by 1.

Spirit Link (10 XP):

Spirits act on your turn; commands free.

True Name Keeper (15 XP):

Call any previously encountered spirit.

Bound Spirit

Name:

Type:

Cap:

Special Abilities:

Price/Bargain:

Spirit Whims Table (When Leash Fills)

1: Reveal a secret.

2: Break something.

3: Lead astray.

4: Call for help.

5: Curse a PC.

6: Bargain.

"I asked the drowned captain for directions. He asked for a memory in return. We shook on it." — The Gray Wanderer

## Ranger / Archer — Build Guidance

### The Patient Hunter — Ranged Combat Specialist

**Role:** Fight from distance, track enemies, survive wilderness. Primary: Wits, Body.

**Core Talents:**

- **Weapon Mastery (bows) (5 XP)** – +2 dice with bows
- **Keen Senses (2 XP)** – +1 die perception
- **Pathfinder — Trackless Step (4 XP)** – Leave no trail in natural terrain

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Wits 3, Survival 2, Ranged 2. Take Weapon Mastery + Keen Senses.
- **Tier II:** Add Trackless Step, then Eagle Eye. Take Heightened Senses.
- **Tier III:** The Patient Hunter (+2 dice first attack after observing target).

**Cultural Variants:**

- **Sekogo Throw-Knife Hunter:** Kpinga returns to hand; Spiral Throw hits zone.
- **Ashaan Chariot Archer:** Chariot Volley (two attacks from moving chariot).
- **Fhara Desert Raider:** Furusiyya Training (lance, saber, bow, horsemanship).

Ranger / Archer — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
|-----------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | /         |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | / 3       |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | / 5       |
| Presence  |        | XP       |           |

Ranger Talents

Weapon Mastery (bow) (5 XP): +2 dice with bows.

Keen Senses (2 XP): +1 die perception.

Heightened Senses (3 XP): Cannot be surprised in natural terrain.

Pathfinder — Trackless Step (4 XP): Leave no trail; pursuers -2 dice.

Pathfinder II — Eagle Eye (6 XP): Hidden ranged attacks Position +1.

Called Shot (6 XP): Blind, Disarm, Hamstring, or Vitals.

Ranged Weapon Modifiers

| Weight | Close      | Near | Far |
|--------|------------|------|-----|
| Light  | Controlled | +1d  | —   |
| Medium | Desperate  | +2d  | +1d |
| Heavy  | Desperate  | +1d  | +3d |

Cultural Archery Techniques

Sekogo Spiral Throw (6 XP): Throw kpinga hits all in Near zone.

Ashaan Chariot Volley (8 XP): Two attacks from moving chariot.

Fhara Horse Archery (8 XP): Fire from horseback without penalty.

Sidhi Javelin Volley (6 XP): Throw two javelins as one action.

Sample Build — Tier I Ranger (36XP)

Attributes: Wits 3 (9), Body 2 (6), Spirit 2 (6) — 21 XP

Skills: Ranged 2 (4), Survival 2 (4), Stealth 1 (2) — 10 XP

Talents: Weapon Mastery (5) — 5 XP

Total: 36 XP

"The kpinga does not fly. It dances. And the dance always ends with blood." — Mkara, Sekogo hunter

## Commander / Warlord — Build Guidance

### The Leader — Force Multiplier

**Role:** Direct allies, control battlefields, shape conflicts through strategy. Primary: Presence, Wits.

**Core Talents:**

- **Command Presence (4 XP)** – +1 die leadership/intimidation
- **Inspire (3 XP)** – Give ally +1 Boon and +1 die on next roll
- **Tactical Movement (4 XP)** – Reposition without disengaging

**Progression Path:**

- **Tier I:** Presence 3, Command 2, Tactics 1. Take Command Presence + Inspire.
- **Tier II:** Add Tactical Movement, Network Weaver. Acquire Cap 2-3 follower.
- **Tier III:** Battlefield Mastery (when outnumbered, +1 Effect, enemies -1 die).

**Follower Management:**

- **Cap 2-3:** Reliable support, can take independent actions
- **Cap 4-5:** Trusted lieutenants; can manage Assets
- **Loyalty states:** Faithful → Strained → Broken
- **Fitness states:** Ready → Hurt → Down

Commander / Warlord — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Tier / XP:

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track                  |
|-----------|--------|----------|----------------------------|
| Body      |        | Fatigue  | <div></div> <div>/</div>   |
| Wits      |        | Harm     | <div></div> <div>/ 3</div> |
| Spirit    |        | Boons    | <div></div> <div>/ 5</div> |
| Presence  |        | XP       | <div></div>                |

Command Talents

Command Presence (4 XP):

Inspire (3 XP):

Tactical Movement (4 XP):

Network Weaver (4 XP):

Battlefield Mastery (6 XP):

+1 die leadership/intimidation.

Once/scene, grant ally +1 Boon and +1 die.

Reposition without disengaging.

Gain minor contact in each new settlement.

When outnumbered, +1 Effect, enemies -1 die.

Followers

| Name | Cap / Role |
|------|------------|
| 1:   |            |
| 2:   |            |
| 3:   |            |

Loyalty: Faithful /

Strained / Broken

Fitness: Ready / Hurt / Down

Unit Tactics Reference

Aid Action:

Setup:

Rally:

Delegated Upkeep (5 XP):

Spend 1 Boon for +1 die to ally.

Grant ally +1 Position or step up Effect.

Command roll to remove Fear conditions.

Cap 4+ follower manages Assets.

Sample Build — Tier I Commander (36XP)

Attributes:

Skills:

Talents:

Total:

Presence 3 (9), Wits 2 (6), Body 2 (6) — 21 XP

Command 2 (4), Tactics 2 (4), Sway 1 (2) — 10 XP

Command Presence (4), Inspire (3) — 7 XP

38 XP (adjust as needed)

"The elephant does not charge. It walks. And everything in its path becomes mud." — Rajah Anant, Dhaharan mahout

## Forger / Artificer — Build Guidance

### The Maker — Crafting and Forgery

**Role:** Create, repair, forge documents, build devices. Primary: Wits, Body.

**Forgery Mini-Game (4 Steps):**

1. **Research (Wits+Investigation, DV 2-4):** Learn document specifics
2. **Materials (Wits+Streetwise, DV 3):** Source matching paper, ink, seal
3. **The Craft (Wits+Craft, DV 3-5):** Create the forgery
4. **Presentation (Presence+Deception):** Pass it off

**Core Talents:**

- **Master Tinker (2 XP)** – +1 die Craft repairs
- **The Forger's Eye (4 XP)** – Copy any handwriting, seal, signature
- **Master Artificer (5 XP)** – +1 die Craft creations; reduce time/cost

**Forged Diamond Types:**

- **Cargo Manifest** (legal immunity, one voyage)
- **Notarial Seal** (validates contract, one arbitration)
- **Letter of Credit** (withdraw funds, one use)
- **Identity Papers** (false identity, one scene)
- **Pardon** (commutes minor crime)

Forger / Artificer — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

\_\_\_\_\_

Heritage:

\_\_\_\_\_

Background:

\_\_\_\_\_

Tier / XP:

\_\_\_\_\_ / \_\_\_\_\_

Attributes & Resources

| Attribute | Rating | Resource | Max/Track    |
|-----------|--------|----------|--------------|
| Body      | _____  | Fatigue  | _____<br>/   |
| Wits      | _____  | Harm     | _____<br>/ 3 |
| Spirit    | _____  | Boons    | _____<br>/ 5 |
| Presence  | _____  | XP       | _____        |

Forgery Tracker

Current Forged Diamonds:

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

Laundry Timers:

or [6] — \_\_\_\_\_

Artificer Talents

Master Tinker (2 XP):

+1 die Craft repairs.

The Forger's Eye (4 XP):

Copy handwriting, seals, signatures.

Master Artificer (5 XP):

+1 die Craft creations; reduce time/cost.

Asset Crafter (4 XP):

Reduce Asset XP cost by 1 per tier.

Rapid Construction (4 XP):

Halve Asset construction time.

Workshop Asset

Type:

Minor / Standard / Major

Cost:

4 / 8 / 12 XP

Status:

Flourishing / Stable / Strained / Collapsed

Free Use:

Repair gear, prepare solutions

Surge (1 Boon):

Jury-rig solution, +1 die appropriate roll

Sample Build — Tier I Forger (36XP)

Attributes:

Wits 3 (9), Body 2 (6), Presence 2 (6) — 21 XP

Skills:

Craft 2 (4), Investigation 2 (4), Deception 1 (2) — 10 XP

Talents:

Master Tinker (2), The Forger's Eye (4) — 6 XP

Total:

37 XP

"The right seal is worth more than a ship. A stamped manifest can move contraband past the harbor master." — Madam Serafine

## Healer — Build Guidance

### The Mender — Restoring Flesh and Spirit

**Role:** Heal wounds, remove conditions, keep party alive. Primary: Spirit, Wits.

#### Healing Harm (Magic):

- Requires [HEAL] + another tag (Purify, Strengthen, Cleanse)
- Base DV = 1 + number of tags. Add +2 DV surcharge for healing Harm
- Example: [HEAL][PURIFY] for poison → DV 3 + 2 = 5

#### Core Talents:

- **Field Dressing (2 XP)** – Stabilize dying ally once/scene
- **Triage (4 XP)** – Remove 1 Fatigue, reduce Harm penalty for scene
- **Knot of Mercy (Hedge Gift, 2 XP)** – Remove a Condition (once/session)

#### Patron Recommendations:

- **Oath of Flame & Light** – Lay on Hands, Cleansing Light
- **Oath of Mercy & Grace** – Healing, forgiveness, spiral of care
- **The Carrion-King** – Fertile Death, transformation through decay
- **Inaea** – Hearth-Thread Knot, shared burden

Healer — Character Sheet

Identity

Name:

Heritage:

Background:

Patron:

Tier / XP:

/

| Attributes & Resources |        |          |           |
|------------------------|--------|----------|-----------|
| Attribute              | Rating | Resource | Max/Track |
| Body                   |        | Fatigue  |           |
|                        |        |          | /         |
| Wits                   |        | Harm     |           |
|                        |        |          | / 3       |
| Spirit                 |        | Boons    |           |
|                        |        |          | / 5       |
| Presence               |        | XP       |           |

Healing Talents

Field Dressing (2 XP):

Stabilize dying ally once/scene.

Triage (4 XP):

Remove 1 Fatigue, reduce Harm penalty for scene.

Knot of Mercy (2 XP):

Remove a Condition once/session (no roll).

Healing Rites (Oath of Flame & Light)

Lay on Hands (Low, 5 XP):

Cleanse affliction or downgrade Harm by 1.

Cleansing Light (Standard, 8 XP):

Dispel curse, poison, or disease.

Rite of Shared Burden (Standard, 9 XP):

Transfer Condition to willing target.

Healing Reference

Fatigue:

Short rest (1 hour) clears 2; full night clears all.

[HEAL] Cantrip (DV 2):

Remove 1 Fatigue.

Mundane Healing:

1 week rest removes 1 Harm.

Serious Wounds:

Optional rule — lasting debility, needs quest to heal.

Sample Build — Tier I Healer (36XP)

Attributes:

Spirit 3 (9), Wits 2 (6), Presence 2 (6) — 21 XP

Skills:

Medicine 2 (4), Lore 2 (4), Sway 1 (2) — 10 XP

Talents:

Field Dressing (2), Triage (4) — 6 XP

Total:

37 XP

"The [HEAL] tag closes small wounds and eases exhaustion. To knit broken bones, you need greater power—and greater risk." — The Gray Wanderer

## Velvet Court — Faction Sheet

### The Velvet Court — Silkstrand's Shadow Network

**Reputation Dial:** Enemy (-3) to Creditor-in-Waiting (+3)

**Creditors (The Velvet Seats):**

- Madam Serafine (Information, Forgery, Laundering)
- Old Kes (Fence, Smuggling, Markets)
- The Dockmaster (Movement, Ships, Warehouses)
- Sister Agatha (Cover, Sanctuary, False Identities)
- The Archivist (Legal Precedent, Forged Writs)
- The Gray Eminence (Unknown)

**Heat Dials:**

- **Watch Interest [6]:** Fills when jobs go loud or evidence left. At 3: Patrol Sweep. At 6: Sting Operation.
- **Syndicate Pressure [6]:** Fills when rivals notice. At 3: Curfew. At 6: Crackdown.

**Court Assets:**

- The Blue Ledger (bribeable officials)
- The Maze of Whispers (hidden passages)
- The Ghost Crew (urchin spies, Cap 1)
- The Scribe's Seal (forged notary)

Velvet Court — Faction Tracker

Velvet Court Standing

Velvet Dial: \_\_\_\_\_  
-3 (Enemy) — Hunted; no safe houses  
-2 to -1 — Wary; limited access  
0 to +1 — Neutral; standard access  
+2 to +3 (Trusted) — Attend Velvet Moot; request Favors

Heat Trackers

Watch Interest [6]  

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

  
Syndicate Pressure [6]  

|   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|

Creditor Favor Timers

Serafine: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ]  
Old Kes: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ]  
Dockmaster: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Sister Agatha: [ ][ ][ ][ ]  
[ ]  
Archivist: [ ][ ]  
[ ][ ][ ][ ]

Heist Planner

Heist Timer : [ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ][ ] (6-12)  
Threat Timers:  
Alarm: [ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Security: [ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Inside Trouble: [ ][ ][ ][ ]

Informant Network

| Name  | Reliability [4] |
|-------|-----------------|
| _____ | [ ][ ][ ][ ]    |
| _____ | [ ][ ][ ][ ]    |
| _____ | [ ][ ][ ][ ]    |

Rival Crew

Name: \_\_\_\_\_  
Agenda Timer [6]:  
[ ][ ][ ][ ][ ]  
Goal: \_\_\_\_\_

"The coin you take is never the one that costs you. The one you leave behind—that is the debt that collects." — Madam Serafine

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*The road remembers. Every broken wheel leaves a mark, every lit lamp bears witness.*